

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 1/10: Central problem: one, many, knowledge and stability

CENTRAL QUESTION: HOW CAN MANY CHANGING THINGS SHARE ONE KNOWABLE CHARACTER?

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+--> ONE-MANY: many just acts -> one intelligible standard of Justice

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+--> KNOWLEDGE: episteme requires a stable object, not flux alone

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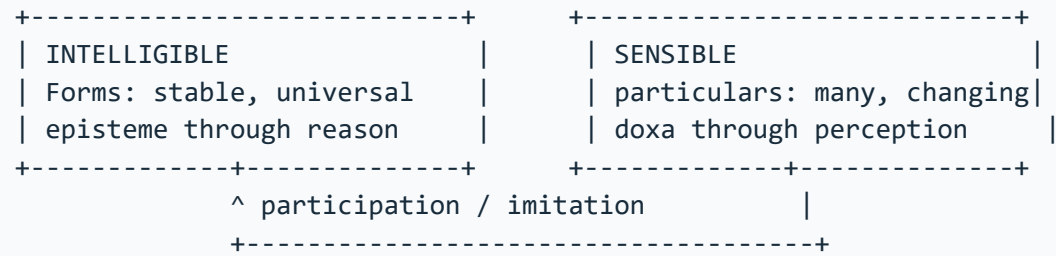
+--> PLATO: transcendent Forms; particulars participate or imitate

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+--> COST: separation makes the Form-particular relation hard to explain

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 2/10: Two-level ontology and the ascent from opinion to knowledge

PLATO'S TWO-LEVEL ONTOLOGY



CAVE: shadows -> visible things -> mathematics -> Forms -> Good

LINE: eikasia -> pistis -> dianoia -> noesis

SUN: the Good grounds both being and knowability.

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 3/10: Participation pressure and Aristotle's immanent repair

PLATONIC EXPLANATION

ARISTOTELIAN PRESSURE

Form F -> participation -> many F-things		participation remains metaphorical
separate paradigm explains common F		separation duplicates the explanandum
		likeness invites another Form
v		v

THIRD MAN: particulars + Form F resemble -> further Form F2 -> regress

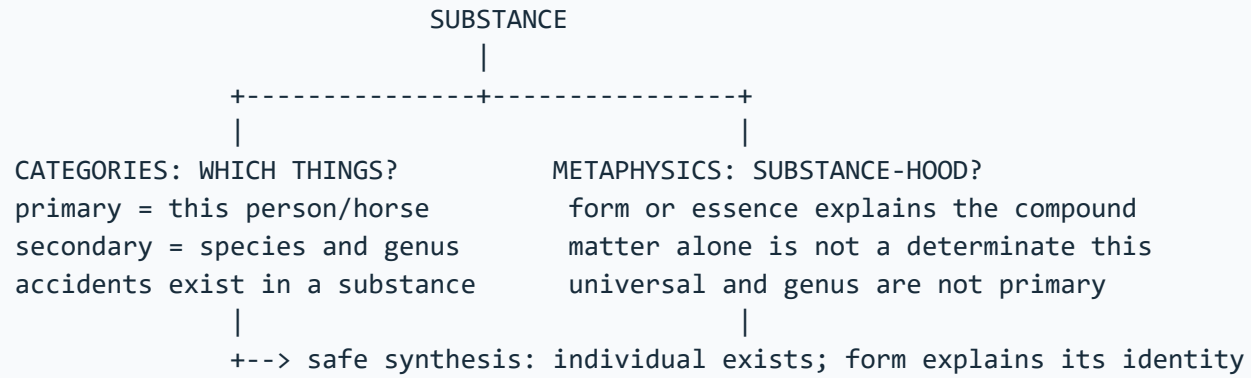
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+--> REPLY: deny unrestricted self-predication or restrict the premise

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+--> RESIDUAL: how does a separate Form causally determine a particular?

ARISTOTLE'S REPAIR: retain form, but make it immanent in concrete substance.

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 4/10: Aristotle's substance hierarchy and explanatory essence

ARISTOTLE: WHAT EXISTS PRIMARILY, AND WHAT MAKES IT WHAT IT IS?



ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 5/10: Hylomorphic composite: matter, form and substantial unity

ONE NATURAL SUBSTANCE – MATTER INFORMED BY IMMANENT FORM

+-----+	+-----+
MATTER	FORM
that out of which	what-it-is / essence
relative potentiality	organisation / actuality
can receive determination	makes the composite one
+-----+	+-----+

+-----+

v

CONCRETE COMPOSITE

bronze + statue-form; wood + table-form; body + soul in a living organism
LIMIT: prime matter is a theoretical limit, not independently existing stuff.

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 6/10: Four causes as a matrix of explanatory completeness

ONE QUESTION, FOUR COMPLEMENTARY SENSES OF WHY

+-----+-----+-----+-----+			
MATERIAL	FORMAL	EFFICIENT	FINAL
made of what	what it is	source of change	for the sake of what
wood	table structure	carpenter and tools	usable working surface

+-----+-----+-----+-----+

NATURAL CASE: acorn matter + oak form + generating parent/process + mature oak telos

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+--> formal, efficient and final causes may coincide in natural development

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+--> teleology need not mean a conscious external designer

RESULT: explanatory completeness is richer than efficient succession alone.

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 7/10: Potentiality to actuality: change without creation from nothing

GROUNDING CAPACITY → PROCESS OF ACTUALISATION → FULFILLED ACTUALITY

wood fit for a table → cutting and joining → completed table

acorn ordered to oak → organic development → mature oak

dynamis	kinesis	energeia / entelecheia

+--> change = actuality of the potential precisely as potential

+--> actuality is prior in definition, end and species-level explanation

+--> qualification: potentiality may be earlier in an individual's time

RESULT: becoming is structured being-in-capacity, not emergence from sheer non-being.

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 8/10: Teleological order and pure actuality

MOTION HERE AND NOW REQUIRES ACTUALITY, BUT THE SERIES CANNOT BE PURE POTENCY

moved mover -> moved mover -> ordered eternal motion

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UNMOVED MOVER = PURE ACTUALITY WITHOUT UNREALISED POTENTIALITY

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+--> moves as final cause: object of desire and thought

+--> thought thinking itself; no material composition

+--> not a temporal first event or material cause

LIMIT: do not equate Aristotle's mover with a personal efficient creator.

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 9/10: Plato and Aristotle on form: comparison, criticism and reply

AXIS	PLATO	ARISTOTLE	
+-----+	+-----+	+-----+	+
status of form	transcendent and separate	immanent in substance	
primary reality	universal Form	concrete individual	
relation to particulars	participation / imitation	hylomorphic constitution	
explanation of change	limited paradigmatic role	causes plus potency-act	
+-----+	+-----+	+-----+	+

OBJECTION TO PLATO -> duplication, regress and causal gap
REPLY FOR PLATO -> stable universals secure objectivity, definition and norms
OBJECTION TO ARISTOTLE -> universality and prime matter remain difficult
VERDICT -> Aristotle transforms Plato's insight; he does not simply erase it.

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 10/10: Answer spine and precision distinctions

DIRECTIVE -> DEFINITION -> ARGUMENT -> EXAMPLE -> OBJECTION -> REPLY -> VERDICT

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+--> FORM: organising actuality; UNIVERSAL: predicable of many

+--> ESSENCE: what-it-is; SUBSTANCE: primary bearer / concrete being

+--> MATTER: capacity principle; CAUSE: explanatory because

+--> POTENTIALITY: qualified capacity; ACTUALITY: fulfilment or activity

PYQ ROUTES

Forms -> one-many + knowledge + participation; Substance -> Categories/Metaphysics

Causes -> four complementary explanations; Change -> potentiality to actuality

Comparison -> transcendent Form versus immanent form on matched axes

FINAL CONTROL: answer the printed directive, not a general biography of two thinkers.